to calculate it. I have no competence to do so but details below may offer some broad indicators.

Until 1911, a British pound was worth Rs 15.10 gm of gold cost about Rs 90. The average agricultural wage was less than Rs 5 a month. Carpenters, masons and blacksmiths made about Rs 15 a month. The entry level salary of a sub-editor of the Tamil daily, *Swadesamitran* was Rs 30 a month. Tamil pandits in colleges made between Rs 30 and Rs 50 a month.

Until 1957, when the Indian currency was decimalized, a rupee consisted of 16 annas and an anna consisted of 12 paise—192 paise to a rupee—and was expressed numerically as rupee–anna–paisa (0–0–0).